

KURSI

A High-Stakes Game of Power, Bluffing, & Betrayal

Welcome to modern India's high-stakes corporate-political underground. In **Kursi** (The Chair), you are a powerful shadow player vying to seize absolute control of the country's ultimate power apparatus. Through corruption, backroom settlements, and outright threats, you must systematically eliminate your rivals' influence. Trust no one; everyone is lying to secure the Kursi.

OBJECTIVE

The final goal is simple: **be the last player standing** with any remaining influence. You achieve this by siphoning currency (**Khokhas**) to fund strategic takeovers, launching hits on opponents, and successfully bluffing your way past their defenses.

GAME SETUP

1. THE DECK

A deck of 15 cards consisting of 3 copies of 5 unique character roles.

2. STARTING HAND

Each player is dealt 2 cards face down. These represent your hidden **Influence**.

3. THE TREASURY

Every player starts with **2** Khokhas (Crores). The rest form the central Treasury.

CORE MECHANICS

Play proceeds clockwise. On your turn, you must choose and execute exactly **one action**. You do not need to possess the character card corresponding to the action you declare; **bluffing is fully permitted and encouraged**.

Any player may challenge your claim at the moment an action or counteraction is declared. If you are caught lying, you lose 1 Influence. If you prove you were telling the truth, the challenger loses 1 Influence instead.

GENERAL ACTIONS

These core actions can be performed by any player on their turn and cannot be blocked or countered by any specific character.

- **Dehaadi (Daily Wage):** Take **1** Khokha from the central treasury. This action is completely safe.

- **FDI (Foreign Direct Investment):** Take **2** Khokhas from the treasury. *Warning: This action can be blocked by anyone claiming to hold the Neta card.*
- **Khela (The Masterstroke):** Pay **7** Khokhas to the central treasury. Target one rival player; they must instantly choose one of their face-down influence cards to reveal and lose forever. This action cannot be blocked or challenged.

Mandatory Khela Rule: If you begin your turn with **10** or more Khokhas in your possession, you are prohibited from taking any other action and **must** declare a **Khela**.

CHARACTER ROLES & ACTIONS

Every character features an exclusive Action they can launch on their turn, or a Counteraction capable of mitigating an opponent's move.

1. The Neta (The Politician)

Action — Ghotala (Scam): Siphon funds immediately. Claim **3** Khokhas from the treasury.

Counteraction: Blocks *FDI*. The Neta claims the incoming funds are unauthorized foreign interference and halts the payout.

2. The Bhai / Don (The Underworld Kingpin)

Action — Supari (Contract Hit): Spend **3** Khokhas to execute an assassination. Choose a target player; they must lose an influence card. *Can be blocked by a Vakil.*

3. The Babu (The Bureaucrat)

Action — Vasooli (Extortion): Enforce systemic red tape. Demand and take **2** Khokhas from a rival player (or **1** if they only hold **1**).

Counteraction: Blocks *Vasooli*. The Babu issues an administrative counter-clearance to stop another player's extortion attempt.

4. The Jugaadu (The Fixer / Broker)

Action — Setting (Backroom Deal): Pull political strings. Draw **2** new cards from the deck, choose which cards (if any) to swap with your current face-down hand, and return 2 cards back to the deck box.

Counteraction: Blocks *Vasooli*. Defends your treasury by redirecting bureaucratic heat away from your assets.

5. The Vakil (The High-Profile Lawyer)

Action: None.

Counteraction: Blocks *Supari*. Instantly neutralizes an underworld contract hit by filing for anticipatory bail and acquiring heavy police protection.

SUMMARY REFERENCE MATRIX

CHARACTER	TURN ACTION	ACTION EFFECT	COUNTERACTION / MITIGATION
Neta	Ghotala (Scam)	Take 3 Khokhas	Blocks FDI
Bhai / Don	Supari (Hit)	Target loses card (Costs 3)	None
Babu	Vasooli (Extortion)	Steal 2 Khokhas from rival	Blocks Vasooli
Jugaadu	Setting (Deal)	Exchange up to 2 cards	Blocks Vasooli
Vakil	None	None	Blocks Supari

CHALLENGES & THE RULES OF DECEIT

Whenever a player declares a character action or counteraction, **any other player** around the table can object by yelling "**I challenge that!**" before the action resolves.

Resolving a Challenge:

- **If the Active Player was BLUFFING:** They fail the challenge. They must immediately choose one of their remaining face-down cards to turn face up. The contested action fails completely.
- **If the Active Player was TELLING THE TRUTH:** They must reveal the matching card from their hand. The *challenging player* loses the dispute and must immediately flip one of their own cards face up. The active player then shuffles the proven card back into the deck, draws a fresh card, and proceeds to execute their action.

The Deadliest Trap: Supari vs. Vakil

If Player A plays a **Supari** on Player B, Player B can claim to hold a **Vakil** to block it. If Player A suspects a bluff and challenges that Vakil claim:

- If Player B was lying about having a Vakil, they lose **two influence cards at once**: one for failing the challenge, and one for the successful contract hit!

WINNING

When a player loses both pieces of influence, their cards are revealed permanently, and they are knocked out of the match. The last player remaining with at least one active, face-down card wins absolute control of the **Kursi!**